Weekly cetuximab

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00207 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Infusion visits and care between treatments

Cetuximab on Day 1. No home chemotherapy pump. A repeating 7-day cycle. The number of cycles depends on benefit, side effects and your treatment plan. For head-and-neck radiotherapy: start cetuximab one week before radiation, then continue weekly during radiation until it ends.

STEP 1

Treatment phases and appointments

One larger first infusion is followed by weekly infusions. Bowel-cancer treatment continues while helping and tolerated. For head-and-neck treatment, cetuximab starts one week before radiotherapy and continues until radiation treatment finishes.

STEP 2

Checks after treatment

Monthly electrolytes, magnesium and calcium for two months after the last cetuximab dose; assign responsibility before treatment ends. Response assessment follows the consultant plan; head/neck radiation follow-up is coordinated separately.

STEP 3

Access and practical support

Day-unit intravenous (IV) access; no home fluorouracil pump. Head/neck pathway requires a separate radiation appointment and nutrition/swallowing support plan.

Do I need a port?

A peripheral cannula or existing central line may be used. A port is not automatically needed; the team considers your veins and overall treatment plan.

If the schedule changes

Ask the unit to confirm the next visit and which medicine is being changed. Do not copy dates from another regimen.

Sources: NCCP 00207 v6 · official regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.